



TIPS & TRICKS

Searching the History command using Control+R

I strongly believe that what I'm going to recommend may well become your most frequently-used feature of *History*. When you've already executed a very long command, you can simply search *History* using a keyword and re-execute the same command without having to type it fully.

Press **Control+R** and type the keyword. In the following example, I searched for *red*, which displayed the previous command `cat /etc/redhat-release` in *History*, which contained the word *red*.

Pressing **Ctrl+R** from the command prompt will display the *reverse-i-search* prompt shown below:

```
(reverse-i-search)`red': cat /etc/redhat-release
```



Note: Pressing **Enter** when you see your command will execute it from *History*.

```
# cat /etc/redhat-release
CentOS release 6.4 (Final)
```

Sometimes you want to edit a command from *History* before executing it; for example, you can search for *htpdp*, which will display the service *httpd stop* from the command history. Select this command and change the *Stop* to *Start*, and re-execute it again as shown below.

```
(reverse-i-search)`htpdp': service httpd stop
```

Now press either the left arrow or right arrow key when you see your command, and this will display the command for you to edit before executing it, as follows:

```
# service httpd start
```

Now let us see how we can use the previous command quickly using four different methods.

Sometimes, you may end up repeating the previous commands for various reasons. The following are the four different ways to repeat the last executed command.

1. Use the up arrow to view the previous command and press **Enter** to execute it.
2. Type **!!** and press **Enter** from the command line.
3. Type **!-1** and press **Enter** from the command line.
4. Pressing **Ctrl+P** will display the previous command. Then press **Enter** to execute it.

Examples:

```
# lps
ps aux | grep
apache 25452 0.1 0.2 454232 18524 ? S 08:58
0:32 /usr/sbin/httpd
apache 25754 0.1 0.2 454232 18496 ? S 09:07
0:31 /usr/sbin/httpd
apache 25783 0.1 0.3 461520 25796 ? S 09:08
0:31 /usr/sbin/httpd
```

Hope you enjoy this trick and I hope to soon share more of them with you.

—Sivakumar E, sivakumar.e@gmail.com



Listing the package for a particular binary/command

When you are not sure which package contains the binary/command you are looking for, you can run the following commands:

```
#yum whatprovides "*/mkpasswd"
Loaded plugins: fastestmirror
Loading mirror speeds from cached hostfile
* base: mirror.pac-12.org
* epel: mirrors.xmission.com
* extras: mirror.hmc.edu
* updates: mirror.n5tech.com
expect-5.45-14.el7_1.x86_64 : A program-script interaction
```